

You can avoid unexpected indentation errors by indenting only when you have a specific reason to do so. In the programs you're writing at this point, the only lines you should indent are the actions you want to repeat for each item in a for loop.

### ***Indenting Unnecessarily After the Loop***

If you accidentally indent code that should run after a loop has finished, that code will be repeated once for each item in the list. Sometimes this prompts Python to report an error, but often this will result in a logical error.

For example, let's see what happens when we accidentally indent the line that thanked the magicians as a group for putting on a good show:

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```
magicians.py magicians = ['alice', 'david', 'carolina']
              for magician in magicians:
                  print(f"{magician.title()}, that was a great trick!")
                  print(f"I can't wait to see your next trick, {magician.title()}.\n")
              ❶ print("Thank you everyone, that was a great magic show!")
```

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Because the last line ❶ is indented, it's printed once for each person in the list:

---

```
Alice, that was a great trick!
I can't wait to see your next trick, Alice.

Thank you everyone, that was a great magic show!
David, that was a great trick!
I can't wait to see your next trick, David.

Thank you everyone, that was a great magic show!
Carolina, that was a great trick!
I can't wait to see your next trick, Carolina.

Thank you everyone, that was a great magic show!
```

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This is another logical error, similar to the one in “Forgetting to Indent Additional Lines” on page 54. Because Python doesn't know what you're trying to accomplish with your code, it will run all code that is written in valid syntax. If an action is repeated many times when it should be executed only once, you probably need to unindent the code for that action.

### ***Forgetting the Colon***

The colon at the end of a for statement tells Python to interpret the next line as the start of a loop.

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```
magicians = ['alice', 'david', 'carolina']
❶ for magician in magicians
    print(magician)
```

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